

7.3.1 Marginal Distributions

Given a bivariate random vector (X, Y) with PDF $f_{X,Y}$, the marginal distribution of X describes the probability density of X irrespective of the value Y . We say “ Y has been marginalised out”.

where both X/Y are 0 and 1

Marginal PDF: The marginal PDF for X is

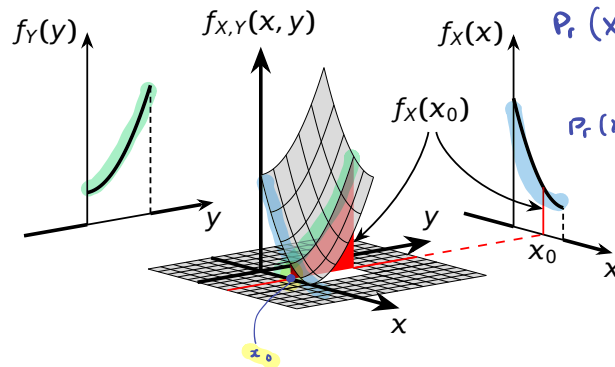
$$f_X(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \underbrace{f_{X,Y}(x, y)}_{\text{function of } y} dy,$$

and the marginal PDF for Y is

$$f_Y(y) = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} f_{X,Y}(x, y) dx.$$

x/y	0	1
0	0	0.2
1	0.3	0.5

For example:



Probability $\rightarrow Pr((X,Y) = (0,1)) = 0.2$

we don't care what Y is

$Pr(X=1) = Pr((X,Y) = (1,0) \text{ or } (X,Y) = (1,1))$

$$= 0.3 + 0.5 = 0.8$$

$$Pr(X=0) = 0.2$$

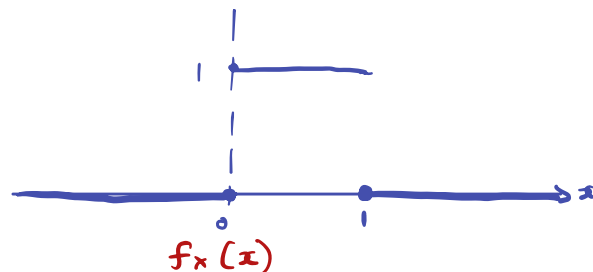
For now think what probability we are going to get X .

Exercise 7 Marginals

Find the marginal PDFs $f_X(x)$ and $f_Y(y)$ from the PDF in Exercise 6 (p29).

$$f_X(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{X,Y}(x, y) dy = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x < 0 \text{ or } x > 1 \\ \int_0^1 1 dy = 1 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$f_{X,Y}(x, y) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } (x, y) \in [0, 1]^2 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$



X is uniform on $[0, 1]$

7.3.2 Independence of Random Variables

In EMTH119 we covered independence of *events*. Here we extend this idea to random variables. Two random variables are said to be independent if and only if

$$f_{X,Y}(x,y) = f_X(x)f_Y(y) \quad \leftarrow$$

for every $(x,y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$, or equivalently

$$F_{X,Y}(x,y) = F_X(x)F_Y(y)$$

for every $(x,y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Independence can arise in two distinct ways. We either explicitly assume that random variables are independent (think of tossing a coin twice, the coin has no memory of the first toss) or we derive independence.

Intuition

First sample X according to $f_X(x)$ (marginal PDF for X)
 Then, completely ignoring X , sample Y according to $f_Y(y)$
 for the distribution of such (X', Y') is the same as
 the distribution of (X, Y) , they are independent

Exercise 8 Independence

Let (X, Y) be the uniform random vector introduced in Exercise 6 (p29). Are X and Y independent?

$$f_X(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x \in [0, 1] \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$f_Y(y) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } y \in [0, 1] \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$f_X(x)f_Y(y) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } (x,y) \in [0,1]^2 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} = f_{X,Y}(x,y)$$

Answer: Yes they are independent

Exercise 9 PDF From Marginals

If X and Y are independent random variables with PDFs defined below, what is their joint probability density function?

$$f_X(x) = \begin{cases} 2e^{-2x} & \text{if } x > 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \quad f_Y(y) = \begin{cases} 3e^{-3y} & \text{if } y > 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

$$f_{X,Y}(x,y) = f_X(x) \times f_Y(y) = \begin{cases} 6e^{-2x-3y} & \text{if } x,y > 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

7.3.3 Expectation with Multiple Random Variables

The expectation of a function $g(X, Y)$ of a random vector (X, Y) is defined as

$$E(g(X, Y)) = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} g(x, y) f_{X,Y}(x, y) dx dy.$$

The expected values of X and Y are found by setting $g(X, Y) = X$ and $g(X, Y) = Y$, respectively. If X and Y are **independent** random variables, then the following properties hold:

1. $E(XY) = E(X)E(Y)$
2. $E(h_1(X)h_2(Y)) = E(h_1(X))E(h_2(Y))$
(h_1 is a function of X , h_2 is a function of Y)
3. $\text{Var}(aX + bY + c) = a^2 \text{Var}(X) + b^2 \text{Var}(Y)$

If X and Y are **independent or dependent** random variables, then the following properties hold:

1. $E(ag(X, Y)) = aE(g(X, Y))$, for $a \in \mathbb{R}$
2. $E(g(X, Y) + h(X, Y)) = E(g(X, Y)) + E(h(X, Y))$
3. $E(aX + bY + c) = aE(X) + bE(Y) + c$, for $a, b, c \in \mathbb{R}$
4. $\text{Var}(aX + bY + c) = a^2 \text{Var}(X) + b^2 \text{Var}(Y) + 2ab \text{Cov}(X, Y)$, for $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$,
where $\text{Cov}(X, Y)$ is the covariance of X and Y (defined in the next section).

EXPECTATION

Linearity of expectation $E(X+Y) = E(X) + E(Y)$

$$E(aX) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} ax f_X(x) dx = a \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f_X(x) dx = a E(X)$$

$$a \in \mathbb{R}$$

} Always!

If X and Y are independent, then

$$E(XY) = E(X)E(Y)$$

PROOF:

$$\begin{aligned} E(XY) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} xy \underbrace{f_{X,Y}(x,y)}_{= f_X(x)f_Y(y)} dy \right) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left(x f_X(x) \overbrace{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} y f_Y(y) dy}^{E(Y)} \right) dx \\ &= E(Y) \underbrace{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f_X(x) dx}_{E(X)} = E(Y) E(X) \end{aligned}$$

Exercise Come up with $f_{X,Y}(x,y)$ such that $E(XY) \neq E(X)E(Y)$

VARIANCE:

$$\text{Var}(X) = E((X - E(X))^2) = \underbrace{E(X^2) - E(X)^2}_{\text{easier to sample}}$$

→ What happens when we scale with 'a'?

$$\bullet \text{Var}(aX) = E(aX)^2 = E(a^2 X^2) - a^2 E(X)^2 = a^2 E(X^2) - a^2 E(X)^2 = a^2 (E(X^2) - E(X)^2) = a^2 \text{Var}(X)$$

$a \in \mathbb{R}$

$$\bullet E(X+a) = E(X) + E(a) = E(X) + a$$

$$\text{Var}(X+a) = \text{Var}(X)$$

• If X and Y are independent, then

$$\text{Var}(X+Y) = \text{Var}(X) + \text{Var}(Y) \leftarrow$$

NOT TRUE in general